

DriveMe — Phase 1 Backend Requirements

Prepared for development · Mansio Group Oy

Date: 29 July 2026 | Prepared by: Sohail Noman, Founder & CEO | Scope: Phase 1 launch (Helsinki · Espoo · Vantaa · Kauniainen)

This document answers the questions raised ahead of Phase 1 backend development and sets the confirmed requirements for the booking, driver, and payment workflow. It should be treated as the source of truth for build — where it differs from the current prototype (driveme-omega.vercel.app), this document takes precedence and the prototype should be updated to match.

1. Customer Accounts

Decision: Guest checkout, no login required.

Customers book with name, email, phone number, and ride details — no account creation. This removes friction for the core Night-Out use case, where speed of booking matters most.

Backend notes:

- Every guest booking still writes to a persistent customer record keyed by phone/email, so repeat customers can be recognised later without forcing login now.
- Design the schema so an optional account layer (saved vehicles, booking history, saved payment methods) can be added later without restructuring the booking table.
- Corporate multi-user billing is out of scope for Phase 1 (see Section 4.4) and will use a separate company-account model when it is built.

2. Driver Onboarding

Decision: No public "Register as a Driver" page. Confirmed.

Drivers are added manually in the admin panel only after clearing vetting. This matches the trust-first positioning of the brand and avoids a public funnel that invites low-quality applicants.

Vetting checklist (must be recorded per driver before activation):

- Finnish driving licence verification
- Driving record check
- Criminal background check
- In-person interview

Backend note: the driver record should have a status field (Pending / Vetting / Approved / Suspended) and only "Approved" drivers can be assigned to a booking. Store vetting-check dates against the driver record so re-checks can be scheduled later.

3. Booking Flow

3.1 Booking types

Two booking modes, matching the live prototype:

- **By the hour** — driver stays with the customer for an open-ended evening.
- **Point to point** — one journey, one destination, fixed fare.

3.2 Pricing

Item	Rate
Driver time	€35 / hour
Minimum booking	3 hours, billed in half-hour increments thereafter
Beyond service area	€0.50 / km past Helsinki, Espoo, Vantaa, Kauniainen
Point-to-point fares	Fixed fare, quoted at booking
Surge pricing	None — same rate at all hours

Action item: the current prototype shows €25/hour with a 1-hour minimum. This should be corrected to €35/hour, 3-hour minimum before launch — treat the pricing above as final for Phase 1, with room to revisit once real demand data comes in.

3.3 Driver assignment

Decision: Manual assignment from the admin panel for Phase 1.

With a small, hand-vetted driver pool, manual assignment gives better control and matching quality than an algorithm would at this scale. Automatic assignment can be layered in later once the driver count justifies it — the booking schema should not block that addition.

Note on customer-facing copy: the current prototype says a driver is "matched in minutes." That phrasing can stay — it describes the customer experience, not the mechanism — but the backend should show a clear "Matching driver..." status while an admin assigns manually, so the two stay consistent.

3.4 Status updates & live tracking

- Live status stages: Requested → Driver assigned → Driver en route → Ride started → Completed.
- Live GPS tracking with ETA, shown to the customer once a driver is assigned.
- A shareable tracking link (no login required) so family or friends can follow the ride — matches the prototype's "Share trip" feature.

3.5 Payment

Decision: Card, MobilePay, and corporate invoicing for Phase 1. Cash excluded.

Cash is dropped from Phase 1. It undermines the "transparent pricing, itemised, no surge games" positioning shown throughout the site and the in-app receipt mockup, and it adds reconciliation overhead disproportionate to a launch-phase driver pool. It can be reconsidered later if there's clear customer demand for it.

Corporate invoicing in Phase 1 means: an admin can flag a booking as billed to a company account and generate an invoice. It does not require a full multi-user corporate portal or duty-of-care reporting — those are Phase 2 features, aligned with the site's "Luxury Chauffeur" corporate tier.

3.6 Waitlist signups

The "Luxury Chauffeur" and "Premium Rental" tiers on the prototype are simple email-capture waitlists — not connected to the booking engine. Store each as its own list (email + tier + timestamp) so they can be exported for a launch announcement later.

4. Admin Dashboard

The admin panel should support, for Phase 1:

- View and manage all bookings (upcoming, active, completed, cancelled)
- Assign a driver to a booking manually, with driver availability visible at a glance
- Manage driver records: add new driver, record vetting checks, set status (Pending / Approved / Suspended)
- View and export waitlist signups by tier
- Flag a booking as corporate/invoiced and generate the invoice
- View basic booking metrics (bookings per week, by area, by booking type)

5. Open Items to Confirm Separately

- Cancellation policy and cut-off window (not yet defined — needed before the booking form can enforce it)
- No-show policy and any associated charge
- Whether the 3-hour minimum applies to point-to-point bookings or only "by the hour" bookings

This document reflects decisions as of 29 July 2026 and should be updated if pricing or scope changes based on early demand.